University of Essex
MSc Artificial Intelligence
Module: IA_PCOM7E January 2026
Unit 11: Collaborative Discussion – Ethics of Deep Learning

Initial Discussion

The topic under discussion focuses on the potential ethical issues surrounding the use of deep learning models to generate text and images.

In my view, and in the view of much of the current state of the literature, there are numerous ethical pitfalls to consider, including:

1. The risk of a model propagating known false information is non-zero, with subsequent ethical considerations arising from the consequences of generating and propagating that same false information (Kumar and Poonam, 2025; Sivagnanam et al, 2025).

2. Innate societal biases can be inadvertently incorporated into the model, skewing its outcomes and practical utility (Kumar and Poonam, 2025; Sivagnanam et al, 2025).

3. In the legal context, appropriate permission to use, and appropriate attribution of, source training material may be compromised by negligent model development or by model development undertaken by unethical actors intentionally disregarding creator intellectual property ownership rights (Kumar and Poonam, 2025; Sivagnanam et al, 2025).

4. End users who misunderstand how a model works, or the limits of its capabilities, may rely on generated material to their psychological, financial, or other real world detriment.

In other words, generative models carry the same set of ethical challenges as any other source of intellectual property content, albeit in what many people unfamiliar with the technology may consider to be a new format or a novel mode of dissemination.

References

Kumar, K. and Poonam, N. (2025). Responsible AI: Ethical Considerations in Generative AI. *Textual Intelligence: Large Language Models and Their Real-World Applications*, pp. 413-434. doi:https://doi.org/10.1002/9781394287499.ch17.

Sivagnanam, B., Rajiakodi, S., Pannerselvam, K. and Chakravarthi, B. (2025). Ethical Dimensions and Societal Effects of Generative AI: The Portrayal of Ethical Issues of ChatGPT, DALL-E, and Other Systems. *Generative AI: Disruptive Technologies for Innovative Applications*, pp. 131-151. doi:https://doi.org/10.1002/9781394302932.ch7.

<u>Discussion Summary</u>

No peer responses to the initial discussion board post were received from other class members, which prevents summarizing a discussion of the topic.